

BURNOUT, HONESTLY

THE HARD WEEKS NEVER BURNED ME OUT.

SWIPE →

WHAT DID

The fourth arrival of the same fault. Ten years in production support and payments at banks, and that is the thing I remember as heavy.

NOT THE BIG JOBS

Migrations and go-lives had an end date on them. You could see the far side.

THE INCIDENT WE HAD ALREADY SOLVED

Somebody wrote a workaround once. It went into a runbook. Every few weeks it came back.

AND NOBODY LOGGED IT

Someone else spent their evening applying the workaround again. Nobody logged that as a problem. It was just Tuesday.

WHAT A REPEAT FAULT COSTS

More than the hours it takes. It costs people the belief that fixing things works.

Permanent root-cause fixes across the two banks. Not incidents handled. Faults closed at the source, so the runbook entry could be deleted.

WHAT I DID NOT UNDERSTAND THEN

This was a rest policy as much as an engineering decision. Every fault closed at the source is an evening somebody gets back, for as long as the system runs.

CLOSE IT AT THE SOURCE.

Follow if you run the systems.